

Parent Guide — senior / module-08-yoga

IKS Curriculum

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Parent Guide — Module 8: Yoga (Senior)

Your student's age: Senior (Grades 9–12) · **Module length:** 10 sessions × 45 min (~15 min movement)

What your student is learning

This is a serious comparative-and-research module:

1. **Patañjali's *Yoga Sūtras*** — primary-source reading of YS 1.2, 2.46–48, 2.49–50, in IAST with Bryant's commentary.
2. **The eight limbs (*aṣṭāṅga*)** in their classical Sāṅkhya-Yoga context — including the observation that Patañjali devotes only 3 of his ~196 sūtras directly to āsana (posture).
3. **Modern physiology** — polyvagal theory (Porges 2009), heart-rate variability, the vagus nerve and parasympathetic activation.
4. **Historical scholarship** — Singleton's *Yoga Body* (2010) on the 20th-century origins of modern postural yoga.
5. **A 5–6 page research-synthesis paper** integrating classical, historical, and modern-research sources.

What's at stake

Your student will engage these honest framings:

- **Modern postural yoga is largely a 20th-century synthesis.** It draws on classical Indian texts AND on European physical-culture movements (gymnastics, Swedish drill) that arrived in India during the colonial period. Sūrya Namaskāra in its modern 12-pose form was codified by the Raja of Aundh in 1928. (Singleton 2010.)
- **Patañjali's classical yoga is much older.** ~2nd c. BCE – 4th c. CE. The eight-limbed framework is a major Indian intellectual achievement.
- **These two facts coexist.** Modern postural yoga is also a real Indian intellectual achievement — just a more recent one.

Safety — Senior band caveats

Standard rules apply. At Senior band: - **Inversions** (headstand, shoulder stand) allowed ONLY if the school has a qualified yoga teacher AND the student has demonstrated readiness over

multiple sessions. **Default: no inversions.** - **Breath retention (kumbhaka)** allowed only with explicit teacher screening for contraindications. - Standard medical opt-out form required.

Paper expectations

5–6 page research-synthesis paper. Required: - Clear thesis. - **One** classical primary source (YS, BG, or SB verse in IAST + translation). - **One** historical scholarly source (Singleton, De Michelis, Sjoman). - **One** peer-reviewed modern research paper (Porges, Streeter, Pascoe). - Steel-manned counter-argument. - MLA or Chicago citations.

How to help

Helpful: - Listen to their thesis. Ask “what’s the strongest objection?” - Try the stress-recovery sequence with them. (4 in, 4 out for 5 minutes really does slow your heart rate. Notice together.) - For the Day 7 discussion: ask which of three reactions to Singleton (diminishment / enrichment / Western-attack) matches theirs, and why.

Not helpful: - Insisting yoga is “ancient and unbroken.” Singleton’s history is honest scholarship; engage it, don’t dismiss it. - Pushing them toward a religious interpretation OR away from one. The classroom frame is the academic study of yoga as Indian intellectual and physical tradition. - Filming their practice for social media.

On the politics

This module touches on terrain where some families have strong views (yoga’s religious dimension, the “ancient vs modern” question, what counts as authentically Indian). The classroom answer: - Both classical AND modern postural yoga are real Indian achievements. - The 20th-century origins of postural yoga do NOT diminish its value. - Religious and secular framings can coexist; the school teaches the secular framing.

Your student will form their own view through engagement. You may disagree with their conclusions. That’s healthy — disagree by defending your view, not by dismissing theirs.

Assessment

- Summative quiz: 35 marks.
- Paper: 65 marks.
- Total: 100.

What success looks like

By end of module, your student can: - Read YS 2.46 (*sthira-sukham āsanam*) in IAST and discuss what Patañjali’s dual condition means. - Explain the eight limbs and identify what proportion Patañjali devotes to each. - Articulate polyvagal-theory’s account of slow-breath effects on the body, including known critiques. - Distinguish modern postural yoga from classical Patañjala yoga, fairly to both. - Write a research paper that integrates classical, historical, and modern-empirical sources.

Want to go further?

Suggested reading after this module: - Bryant, E. F. (2009). *The Yoga Sūtras of Patañjali*. North Point. - Singleton, M. (2010). *Yoga Body: The Origins of Modern Posture Practice*. Oxford. - Porges, S. W. (2017). *The Pocket Guide to the Polyvagal Theory*. Norton. - Iyengar, B. K. S. (1966). *Light on Yoga*. Schocken.

10-Day Lesson Plan

Module 8 (Senior) — 10-Day Lesson Plan

At a glance

Day	Title	File	Output
1	Three Definitions of Yoga	days/day-01-hook.md	Discussion
2	Eight Limbs (Senior)	days/day-02-eight-limbs.md	Limb quiz
3	Āsana — Patañjali (YS 2.46)	days/day-03-asana-patanjali.md	Practical + reflection
4	Sūrya Namaskāra	days/day-04-sun-salutation.md	Practical observation
5	Prāṇāyāma + Primary Source	days/day-05-pranayama.md	Formative
6	Polyvagal Theory	days/day-06-polyvagal.md	Reading response
7	Modern Postural Yoga	days/day-07-modern-yoga.md	Discussion
8	Project Session 1	days/day-08-project-session-1.md	Outline
9	Project Session 2	days/day-09-project-session-2.md	Draft
10	Final	days/day-10-final-assessment.md	Summative + paper

Pacing notes

- Each session opens with ~10–12 min movement, then theory/discussion.
- Day 6 (Porges reading) is dense — budget 25 min for reading + discussion.

- Day 7 (modern postural yoga history) often surprises students; allow space for surprise.

What students leave with

- Direct primary-source quotations from the Yoga Sūtras.
- Practical safe foundation in five āsanas + Sūrya Namaskāra + counted breath.
- Understanding of polyvagal-theory framing for yoga's effects.
- Critical understanding that modern postural yoga has a specific (and recent) lineage.
- One research-synthesis paper.

Homework

Homework — Module 8 (Senior)

Night	Task	Time
Day 1 → 2	Read Bryant's intro to <i>Yoga Sūtras</i> . Note 1 question.	25 min
Day 2 → 3	Memorise the 8 limbs in Sanskrit.	15 min
Day 3 → 4	Practise tādāsana + vṛkṣāsana + balāsana. Reflect: <i>sthira-sukham</i> ?	15 min
Day 4 → 5	Read YS 2.49–53 in Bryant's translation.	25 min
Day 5 → 6	Prepare for Porges reading; read teacher-prepared synopsis.	15 min
Day 6 → 7	Read Singleton's intro to <i>Yoga Body</i> .	30 min
Day 7 → 8	Submit project plan: topic + thesis + 3 sources.	30 min
Day 8 → 9	Draft 1.5–2 pages.	60–90 min
Day 9 → 10	Complete draft, format, citations.	60–90 min